



United States
Attorney's Office
District of South Carolina



Aiken Men Sentenced to Federal Prison for Defrauding Elderly Woman in Will Scheme

Tuesday, September 16, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, District of South
Carolina

COLUMBIA, S.C. — Cody Lee Anderson, 38, of Aiken, has been sentenced to two years in federal prison for conspiracy to commit bank fraud. His co-defendant, Thomas Allen Bateman, 51, also of Aiken, was also sentenced to two years in prison earlier this year.

Evidence obtained in the investigation revealed that sometime during the pandemic, a will was executed by a woman in Aiken that purported to leave the entirety of her estate, which was worth approximately \$20 million to co-conspirator Thomas Allen Bateman, Jr. Anderson was designated as the personal representative and stood to be paid a fee of 5%, or \$1 million. Evidence developed during the investigation indicated the 88-year-old woman did not have the mental capacity to make an informed decision regarding the disposition of her assets.

United States District Judge Joseph F. Anderson Jr. sentenced Anderson to 24 months' imprisonment, to be followed by a three-year term of court-ordered supervision. Bateman was sentenced to 24 months' imprisonment to be followed by a three-year term of supervision. There is no parole in the federal system.

This case was investigated by the FBI Columbia Field Office and the South Carolina Attorney General's Office Vulnerable Adults and Medicaid Provider Fraud unit (VAMPF). Assistant U.S. Attorneys Scott Matthews and Winston Holliday are prosecuting the case.

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Updated September 18, 2025

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